Romantic Era & Early 20th-Century Music
Exam Review

Music 101 · Intro to Music

NAME _____ DATE _____ SCORE / 36

Part A	Part B	Part C	Part D
Multiple choice · 8 pts	Matching · 8 pts	Fill in the blank · 8 pts	Short answer · 12 pts

Read each direction before you start. Write clearly in pen or pencil. Each blank is worth one point.

PART A Multiple choice

1 pt each

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1 What is a Lied?

- (A) A Russian folk dance for solo violin and harp
- (B) A German art song for solo voice and piano
- (C) A French art song for chorus and organ
- (D) An Italian opera aria for tenor and full orchestra

2 What does tempo rubato mean, and which composer is associated with it?

- (A) “Steady beat,” associated with Bach
- (B) “Slow march,” associated with Handel
- (C) “Stolen notes,” associated with Liszt
- (D) “Robbed time,” associated with Chopin

3 What is verismo, and which composer is associated with it?

(A) The 19th-century trend toward realism in opera, associated with Puccini

(B) The 18th-century trend toward classical balance in opera, associated with Mozart

(C) The 20th-century trend toward atonal serialism in opera, associated with Schoenberg

(D) The 19th-century trend toward mythic fantasy in opera, associated with Weber

4 What did Wagner call his operas?

(A) Music pageants

(B) Music dramas

(C) Festival masses

(D) Lyric sketches

5 What historical event is associated with Chopin's Revolutionary étude?

(A) The fall of Vienna to Napoleon in 1805

(B) The fall of Warsaw to Sweden in 1656

(C) The fall of Paris to Prussia in 1871

(D) The fall of Warsaw to Russia in 1831

6 What was Grieg's nationality?

(A) Danish

(B) Finnish

(C) Swedish

(D) Norwegian

7 What is the Festival Theater at Bayreuth?

(A) The opera house in Milan dedicated to Verdi's operas

(B) The theater in Paris dedicated to Rameau's ballets

(C) The concert hall in Vienna dedicated to Mozart's operas

(D) The theater dedicated to the performance of Wagner's operas

8 How did Brahms's Requiem text differ from the traditional one?

(A) He used French poetry instead of the Latin liturgy

(B) He used Latin Psalms instead of German Bible texts

(C) He used German Bible texts instead of the Latin liturgy

(D) He used Italian opera libretti instead of the Latin liturgy

PART B Matching

1 pt each

Write the letter of the matching definition on the line. One definition is not used.

9 ____ Program music

10 ____ Absolute music

11 ____ Song cycle

12 ____ Bel canto

13 ____ Leitmotif

14 ____ Idée fixe

15 ____ Celesta

16 ____ Incidental music

A A keyboard instrument with a bell-like timbre

B Music lacking any literary or pictorial association

C Program music written to accompany plays

D A musical setting of the Mass for the Dead

E Wagner's recurring melodic theme suggesting a character, emotion, idea or object

F Instrumental music with a literary or pictorial association

G Florid melodic lines sung by voices of great agility and purity of tone

H Berlioz's recurring main theme, transformed in each movement, representing the beloved

I A group of Lieder unified by a descriptive or narrative theme

PART C Fill in the blank

1 pt per blank

Write the missing word or words on each line.

17 Schubert's *Erlking* sets a poem by _____ , and one singer portrays _____ characters.

18 In movement V of the *Symphonie fantastique*, the idée fixe is played on a shrill _____ .

19 Chopin was born in _____ but spent most of his career in _____ .

20 The term Impressionism came from a painting by _____ .

21 Scott Joplin achieved financial security by insisting on _____ rather than a flat payment.

22 The larger Romantic orchestra created the need for a _____ .

PART D Short answer

4 pts each

Answer in two to four complete sentences.

23 What characterizes Impressionist music?

24 Describe the musical features of Joplin's *Maple Leaf Rag*.

25 How did the Industrial Revolution and the piano shape musical life in the 19th century?

Answer key

Romantic Era & Early 20th-Century Music: Exam Review

PART A · MULTIPLE CHOICE

1 B	2 D	3 A	4 B	5 D	6 D	7 D	8 C

PART B · MATCHING

9 F	10 B	11 I	12 G	13 E	14 H	15 A	16 C

PART C · FILL IN THE BLANK

17 Goethe · four

18 clarinet

19 Poland · Paris

20 Claude Monet

21 royalties

22 conductor

PART D · SHORT ANSWER: KEY POINTS

23 Unresolved dissonances, blurred harmonies and shimmering orchestral color, rather than a strong pull to the tonic or a strong rhythmic drive.

24 A ragtime piece originally for piano: a syncopated right-hand melody over a steady “oom-pah” left hand.

25 The Industrial Revolution brought technical improvements to instruments that changed the Romantic sound, and the piano was central to home life, where families gathered to make and hear music.

Print this page separately so the key isn’t handed out with the quiz.